

Business Management for Food Scientists

Science

May, 2026

Business Management for Food Scientists (A20201)

Short Title: Business Mgt. for Food Sc.
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Science
Cluster Business
Author UMCDERMOTT
Credits 5

Level: Advanced

Description of Module / Aims

To provide students with knowledge of fundamental managerial skills and ethical and social responsibility of businesses, evaluate forms of business ownership and practical skills for decision making (cost-volume-profit analysis, relevant costs and revenues, pricing and capital investment appraisal).

Programmes

SCIE-0062	BSc (Hons) in Food Science and Innovation (WD_SFSIN_B)	4 / 7 / M
SCIE-0062	BSc (Hons) in Food Science and Innovation (WD_SFDSC_B)	4 / 1 / M
	Higher Diploma in Science in Agri-Food ICT Systems (WD_18AFICT_G)	1 / 2 / M

Indicative Content

- Management skills: difference between management and leadership, management functions, effective management skills
- Ethics and social responsibility: defining ethical behaviour, social responsibility in business versus profits, social responsibility towards society and the environment, consumers, employees and investors using
- social responsibility towards society and the environment, consumers, employees and investors using food business examples
- Forms of business ownership: distinguish between sole trader, partnership, company; factors to consider when determining an appropriate form of business ownership
- Decision making: cost-volume-profit analysis, relevant costs and revenues, pricing (price taker/setter, pricing policies), capital investment appraisal

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Appraise fundamental managerial skills and discuss ethical and social responsibilities of a business.
2. Compare different forms of business ownership.
3. Determine relevant costs and revenues, and evaluate pricing options and use break-even calculations.
4. Assess an investment opportunity within a financial context.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Class and group discussions.
- Self study of assigned readings, exercises and texts.
- Pre-lecture preparation of readings, exercises and texts for participation in lectures.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	100%	1,2,3,4

Assessment Criteria

- <40%:** Very little knowledge and understanding of the subject matter. Unable to carry out critical thinking or practical skills.
- 40%-49%:** Demonstrate a limited knowledge of the subject matter. May have some problems with critical thinking and problem solving. Adequate practical skills
- 50%-59%:** Demonstrate satisfactory general knowledge of the main issues within the subject. Good practical skills.
- 60%-69%:** Demonstrate skilled and sound knowledge of the subject matter. Show ability to analyse and logically discuss in an effective way. Good critical thinking and a high level of competence and efficiency in theoretical and practical areas of this subject.
- 70%-100%:** All of the above to an excellent level. Demonstrate authoritative handling of complex material and a highly developed and extensive understanding of the subject.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	36	
Independent Learning	99	

Essential Material

- Atrill, P. and E. McLaney. *Accounting and Finance for Non-Specialists*. Latest Edition. Harlow: Pearson Education, Latest.

Supplementary Material

- Scarborough, N.M. and J.R. Cornwall. *Essentials of Entrepreneurship and Small Business Management*. Latest Edition. Harlow: Pearson Education, Latest.

Requested Resources

- Lecture Room: Loose Seated
- EQUIPMENT: Blackboard
- EQUIPMENT: MAC PCs